trainer's guide

TRAINING PROGRAM

EFFECTIVE MEETINGS— HOW TO FOR SUPERVISORS

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This guide will help you develop a training program that will support a safe and productive workplace environment for your employees. It will help you to:

- Prepare and organize your training session.
- Assemble training materials.
- Present the PowerPoint® slide show.
- Conduct training exercises.
- Stimulate discussion that applies to the topic presented in the presentation and to your organization's work environment.
- Document the training and training feedback for continuous improvement.

Training Objectives

When the training is complete, supervisors will be able to:

- Plan meetings to achieve the best results.
- Conduct meetings efficiently.
- Participate more effectively in other people's meetings.

Rationale for Training

Business meetings are essential for exchanging information, discussing important issues of common concern, developing new ideas, making decisions, solving problems, and planning for the future. And yet, too many meetings turn out to be time-consuming distractions from other important work. Poorly planned and inefficiently conducted meetings serve little purpose and waste valuable resources. Just consider the cost of a meeting involving 10 employees that runs for half an hour. That's 5 hours worth of salaries and time taken away from other productive work. You simply can't afford not to train supervisors to plan and conduct effective meetings.

Legal Overview

There are no laws that require you to provide this training. However, well-trained supervisors help the organization comply with legal and regulatory requirements in general. Any kind of training that helps supervisors better manage their employees and their departments is useful and important.

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Training Requirements

Your effective meetings training program should contain, at a minimum, the following elements:

- Selecting meeting participants
- Making adequate preparations
- Preparing a meeting agenda
- Getting a meeting off to a good start
- Keeping meetings focused
- Encouraging participation
- Concluding meetings effectively
- Preparing meeting minutes
- Participating in other people's meetings

Trainer Qualifications. The person conducting the training must be knowledgeable in the subject matter covered by the elements contained in the training program, and as it relates specifically to the workplace that the training will address.

Audience. All supervisors can benefit from training on how to plan and conduct effective meetings.

Training frequency. Supervisors should be trained when they are hired or promoted to a supervisory position. Periodic refresher training is recommended.

Delivery method and format. Trainers may use hands-on demonstration, classroom, and any other methods of training that lead to comprehension and understanding of the topic. There should be an opportunity for interactive questions and answers with the person conducting the training session.

Trainee evaluation. Measures of training effectiveness can be performance-based (observed behavior), or by written or oral test.

Recordkeeping. Training records should be kept showing when the training was held, what was covered, who gave the training and the trainer's qualifications, and who attended.

Basic Principles of Adult Learning

Most adults are self-directed learners; they want to learn what they want, when they want, and how they want. Adult learners have their own style of learning that includes four key elements: motivation, reinforcement, retention, and transference. See the **Basic Principles of Adult Learning** guide in this product for more information about the key elements of adult learning and other insights for training adults.

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TRAINING PROGRAM preparation

This section will help you prepare for your presentation and ensure that you have all the materials you will need. You may use different materials that cover the topic if you believe they will be more effective.

Resources and Materials

The following resources and materials should be available for every training session:

- A quiet room with basic accommodations for the comfort of trainees
- Sign-in sheet (included with this product)
- Printed copies of the training program (PowerPoint® slide show notes, slide show handouts, exercises, and employee handouts)
- Copies of relevant regulations or company policies (if applicable)
- Computer and projector with the PowerPoint slide show loaded
- Screen or blank wall for projecting the slide show
- Copies of the evaluation form (optional)
- Copies of the quiz (optional)

Have the following materials available for the effective meetings training session:

- Examples of meeting agendas
- Examples of meeting minutes

See the **Appendix: Training Program Support Materials** section for a complete list of support materials that come with this product.

Prepare the PowerPoint Slide Show

Before presenting the PowerPoint slide show, read the PowerPoint slides, slide show notes, the handouts, the exercises, and the quiz.

Prepare equipment and other support materials as suggested and appropriate for your workplace.

Slide show notes. The following slide show notes describe recommended interactive activities and materials to have on hand as you present the slide show. Each note is also embedded with the slide show notes for each slide to assist you as you are presenting your training program. They are listed here in the sequence that they are presented in the slide show:

- Ask trainees to describe specific circumstances in which they hold meetings to achieve their objectives.
- Bring some examples of meeting agendas to the session and distribute copies to trainees. Analyze them as a group for effectiveness and completeness.
  Materials to have on hand: Examples of meeting agendas.
- At the transition slide, answer any questions and conduct an exercise if appropriate.
- Ask trainees to describe how they usually start meetings.

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- Ask trainees to describe how they encourage participation in meetings.
- Ask trainees to describe how they end meetings. Do they take all of the steps listed in this and the previous slide? What else do they do?
- Bring examples of well-written meeting minutes to the session and distribute them to trainees. Discuss what makes these minutes good.

  Materials to have on hand: Examples of meeting minutes.
- At the transition slide, answer any questions and conduct an exercise if appropriate.
- Ask trainees to describe the steps they take to participate effectively in meetings.
- Give trainees the quiz.

Customize Slides, Slide Show Notes, and Quiz

The information contained in the PowerPoint slide show covers general guidelines and regulatory requirements for the topic that is presented. You may want to modify the slide show and quiz to meet site-specific objectives and policies or local regulatory requirements. If you have the PowerPoint software application on your computer, you may add, modify, or delete slides and slide show notes to meet your needs. See the **How to Customize PowerPoint** guide in this product for more information.

Customize specific slides and slide show notes. You may want to modify some slides and/or slide show notes to include information specific to your workplace. In the slide show notes of select slides in this presentation, we have recommended that you consider making such modifications.

Make sure that any modification or deletion of information does not diminish your ability to achieve your training goals or meet regulatory requirements.

The slides cannot be changed in the PDF version (included with this product) of the PowerPoint slide show. If you want to modify the slide show notes to correspond to any changes in the PowerPoint slide show, this can be done in the "notes" view of PowerPoint.

Customize the quiz. The quiz can be easily modified; simply type in your changes using Microsoft Word or other standard word processing application. In order to preserve the original document, change the name of the file before saving it.

Prepare Materials and Schedule the Training Session

Computer projection. If you have a computer video projection system, run a test to make sure the PowerPoint slide show runs properly.

Overhead projection. If you plan to use an overhead projector, print the PowerPoint slide show slides out on transparencies. The slides will be clearer if they are printed in color. If you don't have a color printer, your local print or copy store can print out color transparencies for you.

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TRAINING PROGRAM preparation

Slide show handouts. PowerPoint offers four options for printing slide show handouts: six slides per page, four slides per page, three slides per page, and two slides per page (in the print dialogue). We recommend you print copies of the PowerPoint slide show in three-slides-per-page format if you want trainees to take notes during the slide show. See the **How to Customize PowerPoint** guide in this product for information about printing slide show handouts.

Employee handouts. Prepare and copy any handouts, such as the employee handouts provided with this product, or any site-specific handouts you may have.

Exercises. Determine which exercises you plan to conduct, and prepare any materials or equipment you need.

Scheduling. Schedule the class for a date and time convenient to most trainees. Groups of 15 or fewer people are ideal.

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This section provides tips and suggestions for presenting training materials to trainees.

Present to Trainees

The time it will take to present the PowerPoint slide show and conduct the exercises will vary depending on the size of your facility, the complexity of issues in your workplace, the level of knowledge and comprehension of the topic by trainees, and the amount of site-specific information. In general, assume each slide will take 2 to 3 minutes to cover. If you practice your presentation, keep in mind that presentations typically take longer during the actual training.

You can use your own words rather than read from the slide show notes.

Training tip: Consider varying the format within your training program two or three times during each hour of training. For example, switch from the PowerPoint slide show to an exercise after 20 minutes of slides, then return to the PowerPoint. Most people learn via more than one format (e.g., seeing images, reading text, hearing, and activity); a multimodal presentation keeps trainees interested and energized.

Trainee Participation

Involve trainees as much as possible by asking them questions and getting them to talk about their own jobs. Encourage them to make suggestions they may have on how to improve conditions in the workplace related to the topic.

Ask trainees to talk about experiences in their workplace related to the topic. Use real-life examples as often as possible to reinforce learning.

Handout(s)

Give each trainee a copy of the handout(s) before the slide show or after the quiz.

Exercises

Multiple exercises for this topic are included with this product for your use during or after the PowerPoint slide show. The exercises may also be used independently of the slide show. Exercises are an excellent mechanism for reinforcing the training.

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Questions and Answers

Answer any questions the best that you can. Even if you don't have the technical knowledge to answer a lot of questions on the topic, you can still answer the important questions about the way that your workplace is addressing the topic-related issues. Follow up with responses to employee questions either personally, through the employee's supervisor, or the facility's intranet, if applicable.

Follow-Up

Document that the training took place and who attended. Also, provide the trainees with documentation that they have completed training (such as a certificate of completion), and be sure to notify any trainees who failed to satisfactorily complete the training.

Complete these follow-up tasks:

- Distribute the **Certificate** to successful trainees as proof of completion of training (optional).
- Distribute the **Evaluation Form** to employees and collect the completed forms (optional).
- Place copies of the **Quiz** results in each trainee's personnel file.
- File one copy of the **Attendee Sign-In Sheet** with the workplace records, and file one copy in the trainer's files.
- Fill in the appropriate information on the **Training Record** for each employee.
- Within 2 weeks of giving the training, talk to some of the employees and supervisors to make sure they understood what was presented and how it applies to them.

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TRAINING PROGRAM support materials

Below is a list of support materials included with this product to help you prepare the training program and document your activities.

Additional Training Materials

- **Certificate**—A customizable certificate of completion for attendees. The file allows the user to type in the training topic and the trainee's name.
- **Exercise**—An activity to help trainees apply their knowledge of work practices.
- **Employee Handout**—A single-page summary of key facts the trainee should know about the topic.
- **Trainee Handout**—This PDF provides the slides without answers to the interactive exercises.

Forms

- **Attendee Sign-In Sheet**—A record of training program attendees
- **Evaluation Form**—An evaluation by trainees of the performance of the trainer
- **Training Record**—A record of all training sessions for each employee, including the date for refresher training

Guidance

- **Basic Principles of Adult Learning**—A guide for training adult learners
- **How to Customize PowerPoint**—A guide with instructions for using the PowerPoint application program and customizing the content of slides and slide show notes

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